Project Report 5

UPI Fraud Case Study and Social Media Safety Checklist

Introduction

This project focused on understanding digital safety by studying two important areas: UPI/online payment fraud and safe use of social media. With the increasing use of digital platforms by college students in India, cyber risks have also increased. The project included a case study of UPI frauds and a practical checklist for safe social media behavior.

Case Study Summary: UPI Fraud

The case study explained how UPI fraud happens when fraudsters trick users into sharing OTPs, UPI PINs, or accepting fake payment requests. In many cases, criminals pretend to be customer care agents, buyers, sellers, or bank representatives. They often create urgency so that the victim reacts quickly without verifying details. College students are often targeted because they frequently use payment apps for online shopping, food delivery, and money transfer. Such fraud can lead to financial loss, stress, and misuse of personal information.

Social Media Safety Checklist

The checklist prepared during the project included practical steps such as:

- Using strong passwords
- Enabling two-factor authentication
- Not accepting unknown friend requests
- Avoiding suspicious links
- Limiting personal information online
- Checking privacy settings regularly
- Reporting fake accounts or abuse
- Logging out from shared devices

These actions help reduce risks like identity theft, hacking, and cyberbullying.

Reflection

While researching this topic, the most surprising thing for me was how easily fraudsters manipulate people using simple psychological tricks such as urgency, fear, or fake trust. I learned that many victims lose money not because technology fails, but because fraudsters create confusion in just a few seconds. I was also surprised that scanning a QR code or entering a UPI PIN can immediately send money if done carelessly. One personal habit I will change is that I will never respond quickly to payment requests without checking every detail carefully. I will also verify unknown messages before clicking links and regularly review privacy settings on my social media accounts.

Conclusion

This project showed that digital awareness is now essential for every student. Small precautions in online payments and social media use can prevent major cyber problems.